

S P E C T R A V I D E O
U S E R S G R O U P --- W g t n

Volume 3, Number 4 -- February 1987

The first meeting for 1987 is on Monday, the 16th of February, 1987. The March meeting will be the 16th of March, 1987. (ie as usual the 3rd Monday of the month.)

- THE VENUE IS NEWLANDS INTERMEDIATE

Wellington SV Users Group

Committee Members

Chairman ----- Darryl Alison Ph 85-522 (Paraparaumu)

Secretary ----- Joseph Dol 889-275

Treasurer ----- Ross Fletcher 788-454

Don Stanley 896-379

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Steve Hanson 843-495

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Other specific areas of responsibility for committee members are

Dqn -- Software Consultant

Jim -- Radio Access & public domain tape software;

Scotty -- Library;

Darryl -- Program evaluation committee chairman & Kapiti users representative.

Ross -- Public Domain CP/M

NOTE - OUR VENUE IS NOW NEWLANDS INTERMEDIATE - SEE YOU THERE

GAMES SCORES

Spectron	12910	Robert Campin
Sector Alpha	2445200	Garry Clark
Kung Fu	82435	Garry Clark
	48705	Garry Clark (*)
S C Force	748600	Deirdre Chin
Telebunny	113520	Garry Clark
	32720	Garry Clark (+)
	31670	Kalima Collinson (*)
Omac	35360	Richard Bremford
	25700	Don Stanley (+)
Ninja	251350	Nicola Tuinman
Tetra	579650	Scottie Baxter
Turboat	68390	Garth Thornton (*)
Turboat	104610	Taane Clark
Sasa	172950	Steve Lacey
Frantic Fred	21720	Rachel Hughes (level4)
Flipper Slip	37640	Garth Thornton
Bats Alive	3540	Colin Chin (*)
Galaxy	1724	Scottie Baxter
Jumping Jack	2600	Colin Chin (*)
TV Nightmare	7040	"
	3640	" (*)
	4980	Deirdre Chin (+)

(+) = started in normal level

(*) = started in arcade level

otherwise practice level or unknown.

----- A note to would-be contributors

Don't let Anyone or Anything put you off. The newsletter is made from your contributions, if we don't receive any, we can only produce a poor magazine.

Presently we are lacking in BASIC programs and in hints to beginners, and from beginners. We try to cater to all club members, but lately we have been receiving mainly specialty items, which are of little benefit to many. Among the many things we would like to see arriving in the mail (addressed to The Editors) are:

- Programs - Basic, Pascal, Assembly, You Name It.
- Programming hints, and techniques.
- Utilities - any type, as long as they are self explanatory or come with instructions.
- News - anything you think other club members might like to know.
- Problems - we will find someone to answer them if we can't.

Everything we receive will be considered.

Public Domain CP/M

Anyone wanting anything from the library of CP/M PD software, please write to Ross Fletcher at the club address, specifying either which disc, or which programs you would like. The listings in previous issues are printed from double sided disks therefore as most drives are single sided, a whole disc from the list now occupies up to 2 full discs. Most of the programs on the discs are 'Squeezed', this means they have been run through a function in New Sweep (NSW, Nswweep etc. but not the earlier Sweep) so as to take up as little room as possible. They all have a 'Q' as the 2nd letter in their extension, and can be easily unsqueezed by using New Sweep to tag them and then the 'Q' option to unsqueeze them, usually onto another disc. Please send discs, rather than asking us to purchase them for you, and please send them formatted. Please also include, either a stamped return mailer, or add 60c to your payment to cover postage. We will return your disk in your packaging.

P L E A S E R E M E M B E R

Y O U R S U B S C R I P T I O N

A plea from your committee!

There are a number of outstanding subscriptions dating back over two months in some cases.

As it is your subscriptions which keep the club running, if you want the support of the Group to continue, please help us by checking your subscription renewal date.

Your subscription renewal date is printed on the address label of every newsletter.

As the Group does not send out any other reminders for subscriptions, we have been allowing some latitude with issues being produced every two months.

If your subs are due before say April, please forward them to the Club's P.O. Box 26050 - Newlands, WELLINGTON.

Remember - the subs are only:

\$18.00 For NZ Residents
NZ\$30 For Australasian Subscriptions
NZ\$40 For other areas overseas.

Another Plea

RADIO ACCESS

BROADCASTS

If anyone has a lack of Inspiration how about some

Holiday-time Programs

for the February/March Radio Access Broadcasts. Please contact Jim or send something along to our Next meeting.

SPECTRAVIDEO PUBLIC DOMAIN BASIC PROGRAMES

Since the founding of the Wellington group Gary Clark has looked after the P.D tapes. He has done an excellent job over this period and I would like to thank him on behalf of all the members who have benefited from his efforts.

He was instrumental in starting up the broadcasts from 2YB Access Radio which has resulted in many interesting and helpful ideas being distributed in an exciting, and to many of us, new way of receiving programmes.

Gary and his family have moved to Auckland and he has had to give up his P.D duties. We all wish him and his family every success in their new adventures.

The P.D tapes and future broadcasts will now be handled by me (Jim Oliver). I now have single sided disc drives which will enable me to offer the P.D BASIC programmes on disc as well as tape.

If you want any P.D programmes on disc please supply formatted discs sufficient for your needs along with a list of the required programmes. At this stage we intend to offer the same titles as are on tape. The transferring of these has not yet taken place so there may be some small changes due to space requirements etc. Remember that a few of the adventure games, such as Planet of Zandall and Volcano Island will not run from disc as these are too large. We may be able to supply them as ASCII files on disc at a later stage if required, but really these and a few others are better on tape.

The cost for copying a disc is the same as the handling charge made for tapes viz: \$2.50 for each disc.

We will continue to broadcast the P.D programmes on 2YB Access Radio on 783 kHz. every first Saturday of the month. Gary advises us that this service may be jeopardised due to some rearrangements by Radio N.Z. of the 2YB transmitting aerial. We will cross that bridge when we come to it.

Software can be ordered from: SV PD (BASIC) Software,
P.O Box 26 050,
Newlands, Wellington,
New Zealand.

Jim Oliver

(Please send any Basic Programs to Jim at the above address if you would like to see them included in the Public Domain. Ed)

FOR SALE

>>>>>>> SV-328 & SV-605 EXPANDER

WITH

2 Single sided disk drives
Centronics interface
Plenty of software

An opportunity not to be missed for those thinking of upgrading to a disk based system.

Any offers?

Phone Garth Thornton on 872-532, or see him at the meeting.

QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

When a STAT *.* command is issued, there is a column of numbers headed Ext. What do they mean?

One of the options in the NSWEEP menu is Y - Set file status. I have tried quite a few things with this, and it doesn't seem to do anything. Does anyone know what this option is supposed to do?

If you know the answer to either of these questions, pickup a pen (NOW!) and write to: The Editors (Q & A)
PO Box 26 050
Newlands, Wellington
New Zealand

We would like to make this column a regular feature every issue, so lets have some more questions. This is one of the functions of the group (ie sharing each others information), so come on every one. You can't tell me you don't have any "I wonder why....?" or "Does any one know...?" kinda questions. Put pen to paper (or digits to keys) and put in a question. BASIC (disk or cass), CP/M, dBase II, Wordstar, machine code, ROMs, RAMs, you name it, you have a question to ask.

EXPLORING BASIC - Part 4

By L.A.Dunning
(Courtesy of SV Australasian Users Group)

This month I give some detail to the modes of display used by the Spectravideo and some software support given to it. You may have been wondering how BASIC kept a record of the TMS 99xx registers if they are write only - and not read?

The answer is that it uses several mirror locations in high memory to do so. Not all registers are noted however, only registers 0, 1, and 7. FE3Ch copies register 0, FA07h copies register 1. FA0Ah, FA0Bh, and FA0Ch are pigeon holes for foreground, background and border colours respectively. Other registers are set to default values and don't change unless another SCREEN type is set up, and so all driver routines in BASIC are designed around these values. The values of each register (and equivalent VRAM locations) are listed in Table 1.

TABLE 1

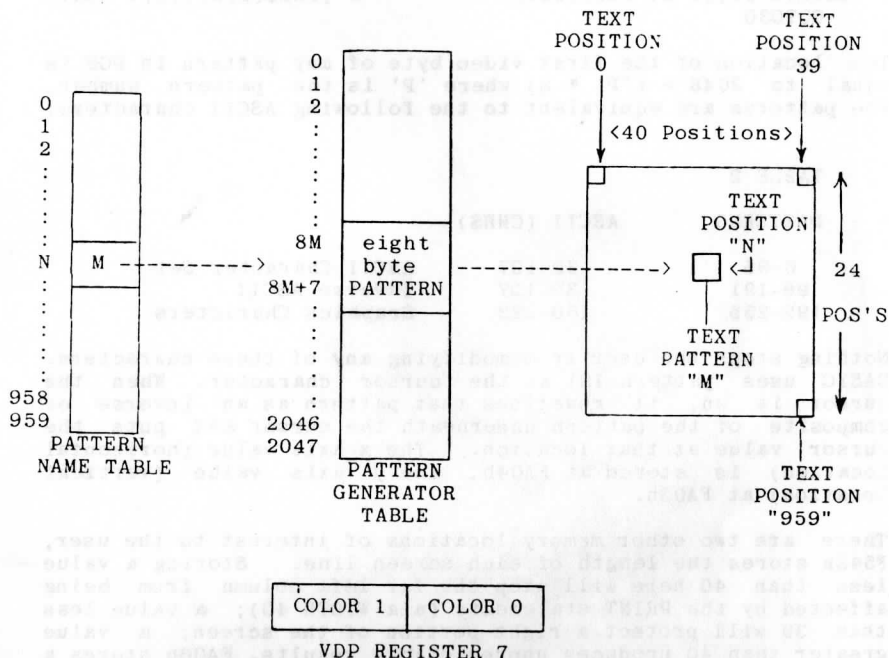
SCREEN (Mode) REGISTER	0 (Text)	1 (Grph II)	2 (Multi)
2 NTB	00 (0000)	06 (1800)	02 (0800)
3 COLB	NU	FF (3FC0)	NU
4 PGB	01 (0800)	00 (0000)	00 (0000)
5 SAB	NU	36 (1B00)	36 (1B00)
6 SPGB	NU	07 (3800)	07 (3800)

(NU = NOT USED IN THAT MODE)

TEXT MODE (Screen 0)

The display is in Text mode when bit 4 of register 1 is set to 1 and bit 3 of the same register and bit 1 of register 0 are set to 0. In this mode the screen is divided into 40 positions across by 24 positions down. Each position is represented by a single byte in the name table (NTB) which is 960 bytes long, so each position could be any of 256 different patterns. The pattern Generator Table (PGB) contains a definition of 256 patterns, each 8 bytes long, forming a block of 2048 bytes. The NTB and PGB have a one-to-one correspondence so that a value in the NTB will indicate which 8-byte-pattern will be displayed. (Fig 1 illustrates this).

FIGURE 1



Only the six most significant bits of the pattern byte are displayed. The top 4 bits of register 7 define the text colour, while the bottom 4 bits define the background. When SCREEN 0 is initialised, BASIC sets up the proper addresses and colours, then clears the screen by zeroing all bytes on the NTB. The 256 patterns are then loaded from a table and in compressed form into the PGB. This table starts at 4198h with the compressed code for <SPACE> and ends at 4551h with the codes 'i' in 'Suzuki'. Listing 1 is a simple program to demonstrate this coding.

(NB in the following 2 listings, @ = \ (backslash)

LISTING 1

```
-----
10 CLS: CLEAR 2000: SCREEN 0,0: DIM B(6),P(8)
20 DEF FNBS(X) = STRING$( 8 - LEN( BIN$(X) ),"0") + BIN$(X)
30 LOCATE 5,5: PRINT CHR$(27)"1";:INPUT "PATTERN NUMBER 0-158"
   ;PN
40 BS="": FOR A = 0 TO 5: B(A) = PEEK( &H4198+PN*6+A ): BS = BS
   + FNBS(B(A)): NEXT
50 FOR A = 0 TO 7: P(A) = VAL("&B"+MIDS( BS,A*6+1,6 )) * 4: NEXT
60 LOCATE 5,10: PRINT"BYTES      PATTERN": FOR A = 0 TO 7: IF A<6
   THEN LOCATE 0,12+A: PRINTUSING"@ @ @ @";HEX$(
   &H4198+PN*6+A ),FNBS(B(A));
70 LOCATE 16,12+A: PRINTUSING"@ @ #";FNBS(B(A)),A;: NEXT:
   GOTO30
```

The location of the first video byte of any pattern in PGB is equal to 2048 + ('P' * 8) where 'P' is the pattern number. The patterns are equivalent to the following ASCII characters:

TABLE 2

PATTERNS	ASCII (CHR\$)	
0-95	32-127	ASCII Character Set
96-191	32-127	Inverse ASCII
192-255	160-223	Graphics Characters

Nothing stops the user from modifying any of these characters. BASIC uses pattern 191 as the cursor character. When the cursor is on, it redefines that pattern as an inverse or composite of the pattern underneath the cursor and puts the cursor value at that location. The x axis value (horizontal location) is stored at FA04h, the y axis value (vertical location) at FA03h.

There are two other memory locations of interest to the user, F543h stores the length of each screen line. Storing a value less than 40 here will stop the far left column from being affected by the PRINT statements (ala WIDTH 40); a value less than 39 will protect a right portion of the screen; a value greater than 40 produces unpredictable results. FA06h stores a value used for scrolling the screen; the number of lines affected by a scroll (as counting from the top line down) is equal to V - 232, where V is the value stored at FA06h (0 counts as 256). This is normally used to protect the key prompts at the bottom of the display.

BASIC also allows some manipulation of the screen by using PRINT followed by CHR\$(27) (ie <ESCAPE>). The character values after the <escape> determine the effect of the PRINT as listed below;

TABLE 3

"A"	MOVES THE CURSOR UP	"L"	SCROLLS SCREEN DOWN (2)
"B"	MOVES CURSOR DOWN	"M"	SCROLLS SCREEN UP (2)
"C"	MOVES CURSOR RIGHT	"y"yx	POSITIONS CURSOR (3)
"D"	MOVES CURSOR LEFT	"J"	SAME AS "E"
"E"	CLS + HOMES CURSOR	"I"	CLEARs LINE
"H"	HOMES CURSOR	"P"	TURNs ON REVERSE ASCII
"J"	(1)Clr TO END OF SCREEN	"Q"	TURNs OFF REVERSE ASCII
"x4"	SET CURSOR BLOCK	"y4"	SET CURSOR INSERT
"x5"	TURNs CURSOR OFF	"y5"	TURN CURSOR ON

- (1) Will CLS Screen From the last PRINT position
- (2) Will scroll in direction, top of scroll is row used in last PRINT or LOCATE statement, bottom is determined by FA06h.
- (3) y and x are ASCII coded characters for Y and X locations, add 20h (32 dec.) to each value to produce resultant character

Listing 2 demonstrates using the above knowledge.

LISTING 2 (® = \ [backslash])

```

10 CLS: WIDTH 40: SCREEN 0,0: LOCATE,,0: CLEAR 2000: PX = &HFA04:
   PY = &HFA03: PL = &HF543: SP = &HFA06: C$ = CHR$(27):
   SD$ = C$ + "L": SU$ = C$ + "M": CL$ = C$ + "I": J=RND(-TIME)
20 STOPON: ON STOP GOSUB 240:ON ERROR GOTO230: KEY ON: ON KEY
   GOSUB 70,80,90,100,110,120,130,140,150,160
30 DEF FNR(X) = FIX(RND(X)*X+1): FOR A = 1TO10: DS(A)=STRINGS(40,
   34+A): NEXT
40 LOCATE 0,10,0: PRINT C$("I");: INPUT" Line Length, Bottom Line
   , Top";LL,BS,TP: IF LL>40 OR LL<10 OR BS>23 OR BS<5 OR TP<
   0 OR (TP>BS-2) GOTO 40 ELSE CLS
50 GOSUB 170
60 GOTO 60
70 LOCATE 0,TP: PRINT SU$;: LOCATE 0,BS-2: PRINT LEFT$( DS(FNR(
   10)),LL);: RETURN
80 LL = LL + (LL>10): GOSUB 170: RETURN
90 BS = BS + (BS>4): GOSUB 170: RETURN
100 TP = TP - (TP<BS-3): GOSUB 170: RETURN
110 CLS: GOSUB 170: RETURN
120 LOCATE 0,TP: PRINT SD$;: PRINT LEFT$( DS(FNR(10)) ,LL);:
   RETURN
130 LL = LL - (LL<40): GOSUB 170: RETURN
140 BS = BS - (BS<24): GOSUB 170: RETURN
150 TP = TP + (TP>0): GOSUB 170: RETURN
160 FOR A = 1 TO FNR(10): PRINT D$(FNR(10));: NEXT: RETURN
170 POKE PL,40: POKE SP,0: SV = (BS+232) MOD 256:
   IF BS = 23 GOTO 200
180 IF TP>0 THEN LOCATE -(LL<40),TP-1: PRINT STRING$(LL,210);
190 IF BS<23 THEN LOCATE 0-(LL<40),BS: PRINT STRING$(LL+(LL=40),
   210);
200 IF LL<40 THEN FOR A = TP TO BS: VPOKE A*40+LL+1,242: VPOKE
   A*40,242: NEXT
210 LOCATE 0,23: PRINTUSING" Line Len ## Bottom Line ## Top ##";
   LL,BS,TP;

```

```

220 POKE PL,LL: POKE SP,SV: LOCATE 0,TP: PRINT"";: RETURN
230 PRINT ERL;ERR: STOP
240 TP = 0: BS = 23: LL = 39: GOSUB 220: LOCATE,,1: END

```

The following USR calls might prove useful as well; 3541h will set up SCREEN 0; 3B86h turns off the prompts; 3B9Fh turns on the Key prompts; 3498h restores the key buffer to original contents; 370Ah will CLS the screen; 3584h will restore pattern values. Next month I will describe how SCREEN 1 and 2 work.

Remember last issues listing that displayed the Keys and input filenames used a bug in the SPRITES() statement coding. There is only 2K of VRAM available for the Sprite Pattern Generator Table (SPGB), when Sprites are 8x8 this gives an available 256 different patterns. When Sprites are 16x16 this gives only 64 different patterns. What happens to the other 192 patterns? They do not exist but the coding still works!

Using A\$=SPRITES(X) and SPRITES(X)=A\$ when the Sprite size is 16x16 and X is over 63, will get and put values from/to the screen. Each pattern is still 32 bytes long, so in SCREEN 0 it affects a 32x8 pixel rectangle; in SCREEN 1 it affects an 8x8 point rectangle. When reading a screen sprite however, allowance must be made that the initial address used is one less than the address used to write the sprite. This is, I believe due to the autoincrementation used by the VDP. The values to use are SCREEN 0: 64-93; SCREEN 1: 64-255; SCREEN 2: 64-111. How do you get Sprites in SCREEN 0? Simple, go to SCREEN 1 or 2 first with (sprite attribute) values 2 or 3, then switch back to SCREEN 0. There is one limitation however, you can't dump an on-screen Sprite to another on-screen Sprite directly; SPRITES(65)=SPRITES(77) will not work. A\$=SPRITES(77):SPRITES(65)=A\$ will work however.

PROGRAM REVIEW

GAMES

SV OLYMPICS

=====

NBS Software

Price \$18-00

Graphics game in which you compete in six events:-

Long Jump- time your jump just right

100m Sprint- hard work for the finger

Javelin- timing of throw important

Weightlifting- more hard work

Wood Chopping- more hard work

Archery- accuracy required here

Full instructions are given on each event, some of which are pretty strenuous on the fingers. Could become addictive in trying to break the Olympic records you set. A hall of fame comes with the territory. Graphics presentations are very good considering the whole thing is done in Basic. There is good use of sound and alternative character font. A good buy at the price for those who can't quite make it to the real Olympics but still have that competitive edge.

AVEN ADVENTURE

=====

NBS Software

Price \$18-00

Text adventure in which you have to rescue a man, get the treasure and get out. Game starts with you standing outside a house. All you have to do is figure out how to get in and then go on from there. If you give the right commands this will be an easy adventure but watch out for the bogus information they give you. Full instructions are given. Interesting use of an alternative character font and cursor presentation. If you like adventure games, this could frustrate you for quite some time. Ideal buy for those with a masochistic nature.

TV NIGHTMARE

=====

NBS Software

Price \$18-00

Ladders and platforms game. Dead easy - all you have to do is go up and down the ladders on each of the six screens. There is one snag, there are marauding TV's moving around the screen just waiting to knock you over, and they move around in various patterns. A good way to pass the time if you like avoiding TV. Good sound effects and graphics. Three playing levels available so it has something for everyone. Possibly a little overpriced but not by too much when you think of how much time has been put into it.

These games are available from

Impak! Computing

P.O. Box 3153

Chrischurch

This outfit is also offering a newsletter called SPECTRA MSX and contains various bumff on both kinds of software and hardware. They have an extensive range of software for msx machines. The annual subscription is \$30. At present I am a member and I will be making my copy of the newsletter available via the library if anybody wants to check it out before deciding.

Scottie Baxter

65 Mark Avenue

Paparangi

Ph. 784-619 (home)

Ph. 729-459 (busn)

-----oOo-----

PROGRAM REVIEW

UTILITY

THE SVI FILE DEVELOPMENT SYSTEM

- - - - BY Elliot Young

Elliot, the author of this program has been a Club member, and contributor to our magazine right from our beginnings. It is therefore based on over three years experience with our Spectravideo Basic - its useful facets and its foibles.

WHAT DO YOU NEED?

The minimum equipment required to use this program is:

SVI 328 Computer	(Of course)
Disk Drive	(Will work on one- or two-drive systems)
80 Column Card	(To display all the information about your BASIC Files, you need all the screen space that the 80 Col. Screen gives you)
SVI-FDS	(The File Development System Program)
Any BASIC Disks	(To work with)

As explained in Elliot's own program summary, the SVI-FDS program itself occupies 5 tracks of a BASIC Diskette. It may be obtained by sending a (formatted-BASIC) Disk to Elliot Directly.

THE PROGRAM

This program is a utility for maintaining existing Files (Programs, Data etc) on Spectravideo BASIC Diskettes.

THE BIG TEST

This being my first serious attempt at a program review, (and being basically very timid), I didn't have a clue where to start, so I took a couple of copies of a nice, full BASIC disk on which to try and do my worst. I next tossed the Manual to one side unread (I'll look at that later, and everyone knows that a manual is the point of last resort ... after everything has gone awry).

I then took my first serious look at the program and its capabilities. I tossed all of my precious disks out of harm's way and ran the program

I was presented with a full Directory listing of my test disk;

containing: A Title - "NO HEADING"
 A pile of "Track Usage" Statistics
 The Number of files
 Available space on Disk
 Disk Status - "UNPROTECTED" (this will also show
 "PROTECTED" if the disk is protected)
 And a DIRECTORY LISTING: Divided into -
 BASIC PROGRAMS
 ASCII DATA (and-ASCII Saved Programs)
 MACHINE CODE PROGRAMS
 SCREEN PICTURES

Each item on the directory had an obvious 'size' value beside it, and had been given a reference letter.

My first thought was - "What if I have more than 26 files, - What will happen to the alphabetic reference?" I filled a disk with as many files as I could and fired up the 'FDS' again ... No Problems !! - Elliot's got that covered. (The files were referenced A-Z, then 0,1,2 etc...

"What'll I do next?" I looked at the screen for inspiration ... sitting on the bottom was a 'menu' to lead me onwards.

There was a list of Function Key definitions in the usual place (which we'll discuss later) and a cryptic but understandable list of other facilities:

"ESC to end" - So I pressed <ESCAPE> and was dumped out of the program - as expected.

"CLS = K/trks" - As the statistics at the top of the screen gave disk usage in both tracks and kilobytes, this was obviously a toggle.

"ENTER for new" - Hitting the <ENTER> key gave me a submenu to "Insert a new disk in drive n and press any key". Doing so logged in a new disk.

The "*" = R/o and "+" = Rd aftr wt" messages had me stumped for a bit, but a couple of my files showed * symbols - so I guessed that this represented a read-only file status (correct).

The remaining option - "SPACE for menu" was fairly obvious, and provided me with a further ten-option menu screen.

At this stage I thought - "What if I got here unintentionally and want to get out?" - so (remembering the "ESC to end" option on the Directory screen) I hit the <ESC> - "Nothing!" ^STOP ... and voila! the Directory Screen filled out before my eyes. (This is clearly stated in the manual - when I got round to reading it).

FUNCTION KEY OPTIONS

I'll now briefly describe the Function Key options. Keys 1 to 5 and key 7, relate to individual file operations. In each case the individual file is referred to by it's "PROGRAM LETTER" (i.e. the reference letter referred to above in the prompt line). Of the individual file functions: (LOAD DELETE PROTECT UNPROTECT RENAME VIEW) only PROTECT/UNPROTECT needs explanation. These set/delete Read-Only or Read-After-Write Protection for individual files.

The other Functions on keys 6, 8, 9 & 10 are multi-file or disk options:

STATISTICS - Gives disk usage statistics for each of the Directory categorys (BASIC PROGRAMS, ASCII DATA, MACHINE CODE, SCREEN SAVES).

CHANGE DRIVES - Allows logging in of Drive #2

MULTI PROG - Gives the opportunity to Delete, Protect, or Unprotect several files from a sub-menu. This is well protected - so that accidental Bulk deletion is virtually impossible.

DISK MAP - Gives you a track by track listing of where your files are stored (but if a program is on more than one track the order is not indicated) with the percentage of track that is occupied by each file.

Note: Each of the above functions take you to a sub-menu of some sort. You can return to the main directory at this stage by typing ^STOP.

OPTIONS FROM THE MENU

When <SPACE> is pressed, the 'Additional Functions Menu' is called. Each of the options offered give a sub-menu which concisely explains what that function does:

1. Set of Change text to execute on Startup (=IPL)

Up to 220 characters of Data may be entered onto this section of disk. You will be familiar with programs such as the function key setup program ("ipl"), which are loaded and run by text stored in this area.

The text may be entered literally, ie CHR\$(34) is not needed for quote(") characters etc. This offers the option to put the ipl text on other disks

2. Change heading on this disk.

Elliot uses part of the "ipl" function to store a 'Disk Title' which appears when this program displays a disk directory. - call it what you want.

NB: The above two functions write data to the disk - before executing them, make sure that the disk is not write-protected.

3. Change Disk Status

Write Protects/read-after-write protect - or unprotect the disk (as opposed to individual files)

4. Stop Disk Spin

5. PAL 80 patch

Both of these are patches to the Disk Operating System. As my disks were already patched - I couldn't check this option's effectiveness - it didn't do any damage.

6. Format a disk

This does the secondary disk BASIC format, ie sets Directory Track back to its initial setting. Disks must have been formatted initially - using svfrmt or CP/M's Format program. This is also well protected from accidental formatting of a useful disk.

7. Search for a File

Searches the directory for a filename or part thereof.

8. Examine Disk Directory

Does an ASCII dump to the Screen starting from a nominated track or searches for an ASCII character in a sector.

9. Test Disk in Drive n.

This does a sector by sector read to verify that all sectors are readable.

A. Printed Copy.-

My printer is not an "EPSON-STANDARD" but it produced an acceptable copy. Later reading of the instructions pointed me to the appropriate section of the program to put in the correct printer codes.

GENERAL COMMENTS

I found that most parts of the program were well documented on screen, and progressing through the Menu System was easy and logical.

I have only a couple of other comments. Firstly, when on the main (Directory) screen, entering any of the valid program reference letters resulted in that program being "RUN" - so I had to be careful what key was pressed (including function keys at times). An option to 'escape' from this "program RUN" facility would be nice. Secondly, 'escape' options are given for many of the sub-menus; this same option could be offered at the main menu levels. Finally, the Search facility would not wait until I had digested what was on the screen. A 'Press any key ... ' facility would be helpful.

INSTRUCTIONS

The five page manual included with the program is clearly and concisely written. It consists of three pages of comprehensive program explanation and another 2 pages of good background information on the "care and feeding" of the Spectravideo Disk Drive.

ERROR HANDLING

The only times I 'Bombed Out' of the program;

When trying to delete/rename a protected file (or Disk)
Or trying to rename a file with a name that already exists

the error message was clear and concise. I found only one 'Bug' in the program (now fixed):

Trying to write a Title 'Header' to a disk in drive 2 actually wrote onto the disk in drive 1.

(The fix that Elliot's described skirts round the problem, ie the Heading uses the "ipl" instruction - which will only write to drive 1. The fix? ... a simple instruction that if drive 2 is logged on the program gives a warning that Headings and ipl changes can only be effected on drive 1.)

SUMMARY

This program is excellent value for money. - It provides an easy way to catalogue and tidy up your diskette collection.

If you read the documentation before 'Sallying-forth', you should have no problems!

- STEVE H.

- -- --- +++ - - -

A PARTING THOUGHT

Elliot's program is not a full 'Disk Editor'. You cannot copy or transfer files, nor can you rearrange the directory or write/patch individual sectors. Other programs are around that can do some of these things but not in as neat, nor as efficient a fashion as Elliot's "SVI-FDS" program can display, tidy, and catalogue your BASIC disks. If someone was to create such a program for Disk BASIC, I'm sure there will be as ready a market as there will be for Elliot's Utility.

Continued on page 19 ---->

MURPHY'S LAW ON BUSINESS

Technology is dominated by those who manage what they do not understand.

If builders built buildings the way programmers wrote programs, then the first woodpecker that came along would destroy civilization.

SVI FILE DEVELOPMENT SYSTEM

SUMMARY OF PROGRAM FUNCTIONS

Version 1.00 13 October 1986 Copyright (C) E. Young

PROGRAM PURPOSE:

: To enable users of an SVI disk system (with 80 column card and 21K free memory in basic) further access to their files, and to perform many disk tasks to save time and repetition. The program is easy to use and user-friendly.

SOME OF THE FUNCTIONS:

- Shows a directory display, including:
 - Disk heading
 - Wasted space
 - Full & Used average size
 - Free space (tracks, % and K)
 - Disk status
 - Status of each file
 - Every program grouped according to file type (ASCII, etc)
 - Size of each program to x.xx tracks, or x.x Kilobytes.
- Allows a heading for each disk
- Load, Delete, Protect, Unprotect and Rename any file at the press of one key.
- Shows a statistical breakdown of the files on a disk.
- Views any file on the monitor.
- Full multi-program operations, including delete, protect and unprotect.
- A comprehensive disk map, showing percentage of each track used.
- Easy writing and editing of disk IPL.
- A complete disk test.
- One key changing of disk status.
- Formats a disk.
- Writes onto disk sectors to stop unnecessary disk spin.
- Searches for a filename or part of a filename on many disks.
- Allows the examining of any disk sector.
- Adjusts a disk for PAL-80 (anti-wobble 80 column screen).
- Prints out the directory display to any printer.

Comes complete with 5 pages of documentation, including information on disk errors and double-siding your disks, all for only \$5.00

This program has taken many months to write, and as I am not a professional programmer, is available at this low price. It is a must for all disk users.

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Basic Demonstrations

Free tracks: 6 - Disk status: R/O Protected

BASIC PROGRAMS

demo	: 1.8K	demo3	: 2.3K	demo2	: 1.3K
demo1	: 0.5K	pipe drw:	0.2K	F	mac: 1.0K
colourspr:	1.0K	patterns	: 1.0K	lo-reslin:	0.5K
sine	: 0.5K	SV-2 put:	0.5K	house	: 3.8K
tune	: 0.5K	SV	put: 0.7K	bird	: 0.7K
tabletcad:	5.3K				

MACHINE CODE PROGRAMS

D1	: 8.7K	D2	: 8.7K	D3	: 8.7K
D4	: 8.7K				

ASCII DATA

SP dat: 2.8K

SCREEN PICTURES

cat pic: 14.5K

GRAPHICS & TABLET

Free tracks: 1 - Disk status: Unprotected

BASIC PROGRAMS

pad	: 0.29	amazr	: 2.47	temp	: 1.00
screenamp:	0.58	lgraphbig:	0.11	draw bak:	1.64
longpr	: 0.11	3print	: 0.11	drawer	: 1.64
lgraph	: 0.11	move scr:	0.23	directory:	3.11

SCREEN PICTURES

Mel	pic: 3.35	house pic:	3.35	NEWS1 PIC:	3.35
MUM	PIC: 3.35				